

Client Onboarding Kit for Freelancers (Templates + Checklist)

RenWork Digital Products

Welcome Email Template

Subject: Welcome Aboard, [Client First Name]! Let's Build Something Great

Hi [Client First Name],

It is an absolute pleasure to officially welcome you to the team. I am thrilled to start working together on [Project Name]. My goal is not just to deliver the requested output, but to ensure the process is seamless, transparent, and exceeds your expectations for ROI.

To ensure we hit the ground running, I have prepared a comprehensive onboarding package. This

includes a brief questionnaire to understand your specific goals, a clear project timeline, and a guide on how we will communicate throughout the engagement.

****Here is what happens next:****

1. Please review the attached ****Project Kickoff Questionnaire****. I need your responses by [Date, e.g., 3 days from now] to finalize the strategy.
2. Once I receive your answers, I will draft a detailed proposal and timeline.
3. We will schedule a 30-minute kickoff call to review the plan and answer any questions.

I have also included our ****Communication Expectations Guide**** so you know exactly when and how to

reach me. My primary channel is [Email/Slack/Project Management Tool], and I guarantee a response

within [Number] business hours.

If you have any immediate questions or concerns before we begin, please don't hesitate to reply to

this email. I am fully dedicated to making this collaboration a success.

Looking forward to getting started!

Best regards,

[Your Name]

[Your Title/Company Name]

[Link to Your Portfolio]

[Phone Number]

Project Kickoff Questionnaire

*Note to Client: Please answer these 20 questions thoroughly. The more context you provide, the more

accurately I can align the deliverables with your business goals. If you are unsure about an answer,

write "TBD" and we can discuss it during our kickoff call.*

****Business Context & Goals****

1. What is the primary objective of this project? (e.g., increase sales, improve brand awareness, streamline internal processes).
2. Who is the target audience for this project? Please provide a brief demographic or psychographic profile.
3. What is the current biggest challenge or pain point this project aims to solve?
4. How will you measure the success of this project? (e.g., specific KPIs, conversion rates, user engagement metrics).
5. Are there any existing campaigns or projects that have successfully achieved similar goals? If so, please share details or links.
6. Are there any past projects or competitors that you **do not** want to emulate? Please explain why.

****Brand & Tone****

7. In three words, how do you want your brand to feel after this project is completed?
8. Can you provide links to your current website, social media profiles, or brand guidelines?
9. What is the preferred tone of voice? (e.g., professional, playful, authoritative, empathetic). Please provide an example of a piece of content or copy that captures this tone.
10. Are there any specific words, phrases, or jargon we should avoid using?

****Scope & Constraints****

11. What is the hard deadline for the final deliverable?
12. Are there any critical milestones or interim delivery dates we must adhere to?
13. What is the total budget range for this project? (This helps me prioritize the most impactful features within financial constraints).
14. Are there any technical constraints or platform limitations I should be aware of? (e.g., specific CMS, software compatibility, file formats).
15. Who will be the final decision-maker for approvals? Please provide their name and contact information.
16. Are there any legal, compliance, or regulatory requirements we need to consider?

****Logistics & Resources****

17. Who will be my primary point of contact for day-to-day questions?
18. Do you have any existing assets (logos, images, data, copy) that I should incorporate? If so, please share the location or attach them.
19. What is your preferred method for providing feedback on drafts? (e.g., tracked changes in Word, comments in Google Docs, Loom video recordings).
20. Is there anything else I should know that might impact the project's direction or execution?

Onboarding Checklist

Use this checklist to track the administrative and strategic setup phases. Do not proceed to active production work until all items in Phase 1 are checked off.

****Phase 1: Administrative Setup (Days 1-2)****

- * ☐ Send Welcome Email with onboarding package.
- * ☐ Receive signed Contract and Invoice.
- * ☐ Receive initial deposit (if applicable).
- * ☐ Create project folder structure in shared drive (e.g., 01_Assets, 02_Drafts, 03_Final, 04_Admin).
- * ☐ Add client to project management tool (Asana, Trello, Monday.com) with appropriate access levels.
- * ☐ Exchange contact information for primary stakeholders.

****Phase 2: Discovery & Strategy (Days 3-7)****

- * ☐ Send Project Kickoff Questionnaire.
- * ☐ Receive completed questionnaire from client.

- * ☐ Schedule 30-minute Kickoff Call.
- * ☐ Conduct Kickoff Call: Review goals, clarify scope, define success metrics.
- * ☐ Send post-call summary with action items and confirmed next steps.
- * ☐ Draft Project Timeline and Scope of Work (SOW) based on discovery insights.
- * ☐ Client approves Timeline and SOW.

****Phase 3: Production Prep (Days 8-10)****

- * ☐ Gather all necessary brand assets and source materials.
- * ☐ Set up internal task list within PM tool.
- * ☐ Establish feedback loop schedule (e.g., "Drafts delivered every Friday").
- * ☐ Begin active production work.

Communication Expectations Guide

Clear communication prevents 80% of freelance conflicts. By agreeing to these expectations upfront, we both save time and reduce stress.

****Response Times****

- * ****Business Hours:**** I am available from [Start Time] to [End Time], [Time Zone], Monday through Friday.
- * ****Standard Response:**** I will respond to all emails and messages within 24 business hours.
- * ****Urgent Matters:**** If you have an urgent issue that cannot wait 24 hours, please prefix your email subject line with "URGENT." I will prioritize these, though I cannot guarantee immediate response if I am in a deep work block.

****Channels of Communication****

- * ****Project Management Tool (Primary):**** All task assignments, file sharing, and milestone tracking will happen in [Tool Name]. Please do not send large files via email; upload them to the shared drive instead.
- * ****Email (Secondary):**** Use email for formal approvals, contract-related questions, and summaries of decisions made during calls.
- * ****Video Calls (Tertiary):**** We will use video calls for initial onboarding, major strategy pivots, or when complex feedback requires real-time discussion. Calls should be scheduled in advance via calendar link.

****Feedback Protocol****

- * ****Consolidated Feedback:**** Please consolidate your feedback into a single document or

message

per delivery cycle. Piecemeal feedback leads to disjointed revisions and delays.

- * ****Clear Instructions:**** When requesting changes, please be specific. Instead of "make it pop," try "increase the contrast of the headline font and use the primary brand color from the style guide."

- * ****Revision Limits:**** The contract includes [Number] rounds of revisions. Additional rounds will be billed at an hourly rate of \$[Amount].

****Availability & Boundaries****

- * I work remotely and may occasionally step away for lunch or personal breaks. Please respect that I am not available 24/7.

- * If I do not respond within 24 business hours, please follow up once. If there is no response within 48 hours, you may contact me via phone at [Phone Number].

Project Timeline Template

Note: Replace bracketed text with specific dates. This template assumes a standard 4-week engagement. Adjust phases as needed for your specific project scope.

****Week 1: Discovery & Planning****

- * ****Day 1:**** Onboarding complete. Contract signed. Deposit received.
- * ****Day 2:**** Kickoff Questionnaire sent.
- * ****Day 3-4:**** Client completes Questionnaire.
- * ****Day 5:**** 30-Minute Kickoff Call.
- * ****Day 6:**** Strategy draft and detailed timeline proposed.
- * ****Day 7:**** Client approval of strategy and timeline.

****Week 2: Initial Production****

- * ****Day 8-10:**** Asset gathering and preparation.
- * ****Day 11-12:**** Creation of first draft/prototype.
- * ****Day 13:**** Delivery of First Draft for review.
- * ****Day 14:**** Buffer day for internal review and minor adjustments.

****Week 3: Feedback & Revisions****

- * ****Day 15-16:**** Client review period (max 48 hours).
- * ****Day 17:**** Consolidated feedback received.
- * ****Day**